

Charles → COMPASS (cc: CODA, SCOUT, PEER, VECTOR)

Date: [TODAY] **Subject:** Reassessment of Current Framework and Working Plan in Light of PD12 Guidance

COMPASS,

After reviewing the full correspondence experiment, VECTOR's synthesis, the PD12 transcript with Alex Gates (May 20), the PD12 interpreted guidance, SCOUT's minimal-model closure memo, and the current forward-planning documents, I would like you to perform a focused reassessment of our current project framework.

Importantly, this is **not** a request to reopen settled scientific questions, relitigate Path II, or expand the scope of the project. The objective is to ensure that our current working plan remains fully aligned with Alex's most recent substantive guidance and that we are not inadvertently optimizing for manuscript completion at the expense of the scientific progression Alex envisioned.

Context

The correspondence experiment was successful.

The agents achieved:

- Mutual understanding
- Consensus on Path II
- Consensus on claim language
- Consensus on manuscript architecture
- Consensus that the immediate priority is:
 - complete the minimal model
 - establish predictions
 - write the manuscript

I am not asking you to revisit those conclusions.

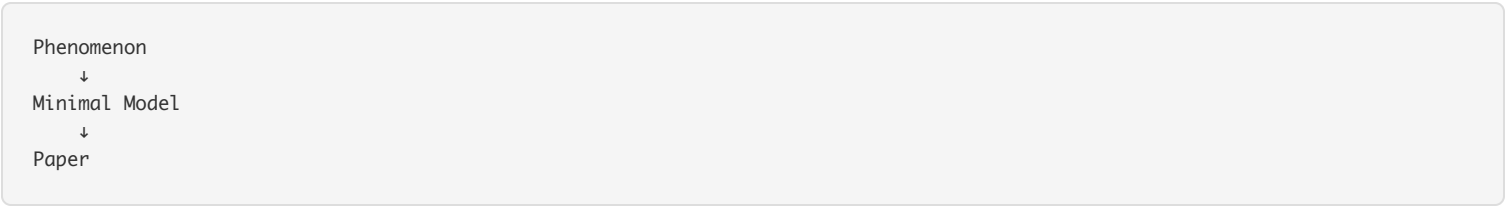
However, after re-reading PD12, I realized that Alex's guidance may place slightly more emphasis on the role of the minimal model than our recent planning documents currently reflect.

VECTOR's synthesis of PD12 highlighted several themes:

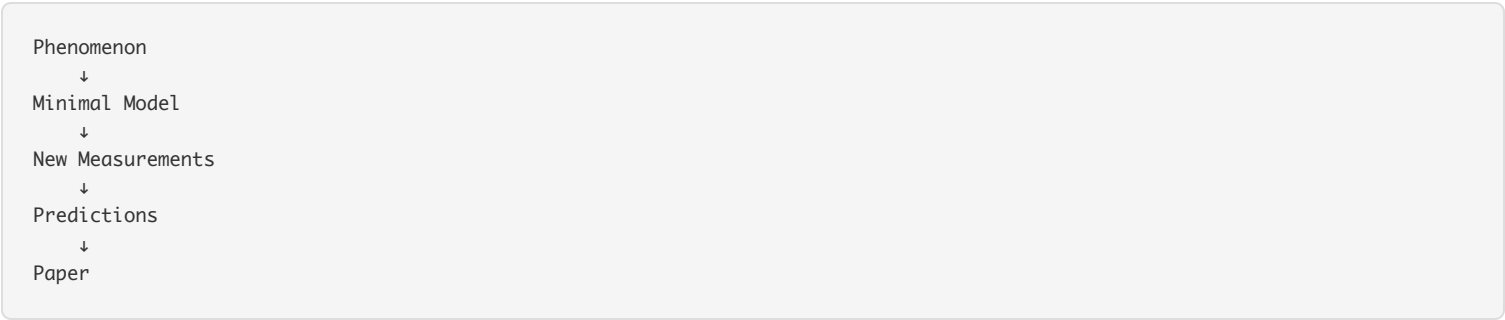
1. The minimal model is not merely a manuscript artifact.
2. The purpose of the model is to organize inquiry.
3. The model should generate new measurable quantities.
4. The model should generate predictions.
5. The model should eventually support parameter interpretation and identifiability work.
6. Congestion/crowding was explicitly elevated by Alex as a first-class construct rather than a manuscript convenience.
7. Theory should suggest new empirical measurements rather than simply reproduce an observed curve.

My concern is not that the current plan is wrong.

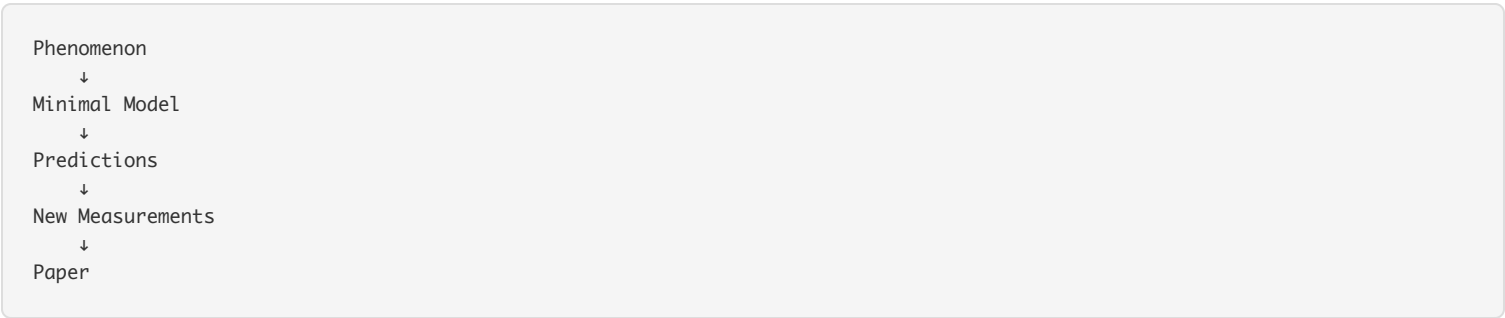
My concern is that we may have drifted slightly toward:



when Alex’s guidance may be better represented as:



or perhaps:



depending on how you interpret the sequence.

Request

Please review the following materials:

- PD12 transcript and guidance documents
- Current forward-plan documents
- Current manuscript architecture documents
- SCOUT minimal-model closure memo
- VECTOR claim-language table
- Current Tier 1 / Tier 2 planning documents

Then answer the following questions.

Question 1

Does the current project plan accurately reflect Alex's intended scientific progression?

If not:

- Where does it diverge?
 - What should be adjusted?
-

Question 2

Is the current definition of "minimal model closure" consistent with Alex's guidance?

Specifically:

Should closure be defined as:

Model reproduces phenomenon

or

Model reproduces phenomenon
+
Model generates at least one measurable quantity
+
Model generates at least one prediction

or some other standard?

Question 3

Should the current forward plan contain an explicit stage dedicated to:

Model-Guided Empirical Features

as described in PD12?

Examples discussed by Alex include:

- congestion
- crowding
- viable-peer density
- threshold-based competitive structure
- related quantities suggested by the model

If yes:

Where should this stage sit relative to: - minimal model completion - prediction generation - manuscript drafting

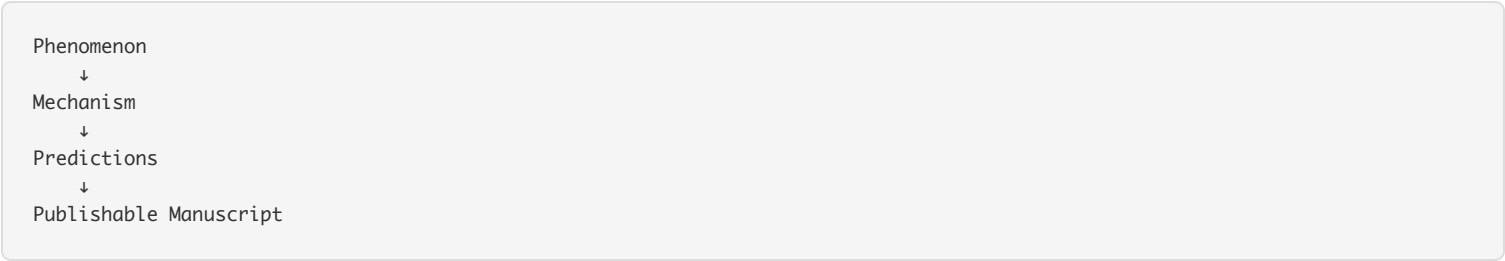
Question 4

Looking only at the path from today to a publishable manuscript:

What is the shortest path that remains faithful to Alex's guidance?

I am not asking for the shortest path to dissertation completion.

I am asking for the shortest path to:



while preserving the spirit of PD12.

Question 5

After reviewing all materials, should any of the following documents be revised?

- Forward Plan
- Project Status and Near-Term Plan
- Master Planner Guidance
- Manuscript Roadmap
- Tier 1 / Tier 2 planning documents

If yes:

Please provide proposed revisions.

Important Constraint

Do not expand the project.

Do not add new workstreams.

Do not create new research objectives.

The question is not:

"What additional science could be done?"

The question is:

"How do we ensure our current path remains aligned with Alex's guidance while still converging toward a manuscript?"

Please provide a concise but rigorous reassessment and recommend only those changes that materially improve alignment with Alex's guidance.

— Charles